

LOCAL NEWS JUNE 12, 2009

Library Column: Readers recommend some good books for summer



George Williams, Latah County Library District



Summer is here. Whether you're going on vacation or just hanging out around town, summer is a great time to read, so this week we thought we'd just have some of our staff and patrons suggest some good books to read this summer.

I'll suggest "Delivered From Evil" by Robert Leckie. This year is the 70th anniversary of the beginning of World War II and this 1989 book by Leckie outlines the basic history and primary events of that war. But best of all, this book, like Leckie's others, reads like a novel - not a textbook.

Since we're on the topic of nonfiction books, Kim suggests "This Organic Life: Confessions of a Suburban Homesteader" by Joan Dye Gussow. Kim says she'd love to have Gussow for her next-door neighbor, but "the next best thing is reading her book." Debbie suggests the knitting book "Men Who Knit and the Dogs Who Love Them" by Annie Modesitt and Drew Emborsky, which includes patterns for not only man/dog sweaters, but also boots, beds, hats, toys, and even a "muscle shirt" for pooches.

For those looking for vacation ideas, Betty suggests "Narrow Dog to Carcassone" and "Narrow Dog to Indian River" by Terry Darlington. The first is about a retired English couple who boat the canals of England and down the length of France with their dog, Jim. The sequel is a trip from Virginia to the west coast of Florida.

And if you're thinking of traveling to South America, Kathleen suggests "The Lost City of Z" by David Grann, about British explorer Perry Fawcett (a real-life Indiana Jones) who battles ferocious insects, tropical diseases, Indians and madness in his relentless quest for the Lost City of Z in the Amazon.

In local fiction, Faye suggests "Citizen Vince" by Jess Walter, because it's thought-provoking, fun to read and set in Spokane during the 1980 presidential election. Likewise, Randy suggests "Buffalo Coat" by Carol Ryrie Brink. Randy says "part of the fun is finding the buildings and locations in Moscow featured in this book written by a local author who weaves an engaging story from historical events." Connie suggests "The Absolutely True Diary of a Part-Time Indian" by regional author Sherman Alexie. Connie describes it as "a truly funny, yet serious, story about growing up and being different."

For younger readers, Laurie suggests "Here's How I See It - Here's How It Is" by Heather Henson, which is about 12-year-old Junebug and her family's experience working in her father's summer stock theater. Sally suggests "Sunshine" by Robin McKinley, which includes adventure, romance (with a twist), and a heroic battle of good vs. evil.

Finally, Landon, a library patron, suggests any books by Lloyd Alexander, but especially recommends the young adult series "The Chronicles of Prydain," which tell the story of an assistant pig-keeper's journey to becoming the high king of Prydain.

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